Position-coach report — Ladd McConkey

WR · Which relevant physical qualities does the forty not measure?

Descriptive scouting information from Combine tracking. No value on this page predicts NFL performance: in this project, tracked Combine features did not improve held-out prediction of NFL movement or receiver separation beyond official testing. Use it to decide what to examine next — not to rank prospects.

Observed movement phases

- [Uncertain difference] Ladd McConkey — band acceleration 2 → 4 yd/s: 6.95 yd/s² ± 0.94; raw position percentile 99 of 93 (for times, lower = quicker).
- [Uncertain difference] Ladd McConkey — band acceleration 4 → 6 yd/s: 5.61 yd/s² ± 0.91; raw position percentile 68 of 93 (for times, lower = quicker).

Physical demand in games

- [Measurement mismatch] sustained high-speed running (partially physically comparable): 26.7 episodes per 100 eligible WR player-plays (82 athletes) — same dimension(s) top_speed, different movement state — largest speed reached: tracked top speed of the forty against the peak speed of the episode.
- [Measurement mismatch] acceleration from intermediate speed (partially physically comparable): 6.8 episodes per 100 eligible WR player-plays (80 athletes) — same dimension(s) acc_4_6, acc_6_8, different movement state — same speed bands; in the forty the athlete passes through the band once, already accelerating.

Film to cut up

- Film — review Ladd McConkey on releases at the line and the first three steps of short movements (early acceleration (first steps, below about 4 yd/s)).
- Film — review Ladd McConkey on vertical movements and long runs after the catch (late acceleration and high speed (above about 6 yd/s)).
- Film — review Ladd McConkey on the stem of intermediate movements before the break (mid-sprint speed development (about 4 to 8 yd/s)).

Targeted testing

- Early acceleration (first steps, below about 4 yd/s) — timed starts over 0–5 and 0–10 yd with split timing, at least two repetitions, recorded from before the first movement.
- Late acceleration and high speed (above about 6 yd/s) — a longer sprint or flying 20-yard segment, because 40 yards can end before top speed is reached.
- Mid-sprint speed development (about 4 to 8 yd/s) — rolling-start (flying) 10-yard segments entered at a controlled speed, so the 4 → 8 yd/s band is measured directly.
- Flying sprint (for sustained high-speed running, 26.7 per 100 eligible player-plays): a flying 20-yd segment after a 20–30-yd build-up, so top speed is reached and held inside the recording.
- Rolling-start acceleration (for acceleration from intermediate speed, 6.8 per 100 eligible player-plays): enter a 10-yd zone at a controlled 4 yd/s and accelerate maximally; measures the 4 → 8 yd/s band from a rolling start.
- WR movement sequence (for position-specific movement sequence, combines the demands above): release → stem at intermediate speed → brake → break at 45–90° → re-accelerate; tracked at ≥ 10 Hz with the same band and braking rules as the NFL atlas.
- A proposed test is a candidate way to measure a demand the forty does not describe. Its value for evaluating NFL prospects has not been established and would need prospective evidence.

Limits

- That a physical similarity to an NFL demand means the demand will be met in pads, in traffic or late in a game.

- That a measured Combine difference causes a football outcome, or that training it would change one.